

TKT-2026-0812-308 - Buyers unable to complete checkout, invalid cart token

Support Ticket | Support

Document ID	TKT-2026-0812-308	Seller ID	S001
Department	Support	Classification	CONFIDENTIAL
Owner	Rahul Sharma	Created Date	2026-08-12
Related Scenario ID	SC-010	Document Type	Support Ticket

Ticket Header

Field	Value
Ticket ID	TKT-2026-0812-308
Seller	S001 - Aurelia Home Decor
Raised by	Ritika Bansal
Channel	Phone, ticket created by Support
Raised at	2026-08-12 11:26 IST
Priority	P1 - Critical (revenue-affecting, live)
Category	Order placement and checkout
Assigned to	Rahul Sharma, Support
Escalated to	Vikram Singh, Engineering
Closed at	2026-08-13 17:20 IST
Final status	Resolved - platform release rolled back and re-issued

Report

Ritika called rather than raising a portal ticket, which on this account signals urgency. She reported that Aurelia's customer service inbox had received eleven complaints within an hour from buyers who could not complete payment. The error message quoted by buyers was "invalid cart token, please refresh".

She also noted something useful: buyers who retried immediately sometimes succeeded. That intermittency was the most important clue in the ticket.

First-Line Assessment

I reproduced the failure on the third attempt using a test cart against an Aurelia listing. Two attempts succeeded, one failed with the reported error.

I then checked whether the failure was specific to this seller. It was not: the same intermittent pattern appeared against a test cart on a different seller's listing. That immediately changed the character of the ticket. This was raised by S001 but it was not an S001 problem.

Order placement metrics showed roughly 7 percent of cart-to-payment transitions failing platform-wide, starting at approximately 10:40 IST.

Escalation

Escalated to Engineering at 11:44 IST, 18 minutes after the call. I marked it as a platform-wide issue affecting multiple sellers rather than a seller-specific defect, and noted the 10:40 start time. Engineering correlated that with the release of Checkout Service 4.12.0 and opened INC-2026-0812.

Timeline

Time (IST)	Event
12 Aug 10:40	Failures begin, coinciding with release 4.12.0 rollout
12 Aug 11:26	Seller calls Support
12 Aug 11:38	Support reproduces the failure, confirms it is not seller-specific
12 Aug 11:44	Escalated to Engineering, INC-2026-0812 opened
12 Aug 12:02	Rollback to 4.11.7 initiated
12 Aug 12:36	Rollback complete, failure rate returns to baseline
12 Aug 13:15	Support confirms successful checkouts on Aurelia listings
13 Aug 09:30	Seller call, cause and remediation explained
13 Aug 16:00	4.12.1 released with the fix
13 Aug 17:20	Ticket closed

Cause

Release 4.12.0 changed the cart token cache key format but continued signing tokens with the previous key namespace. During the rolling deployment some instances issued tokens in the new format while others validated against the old namespace, so a buyer whose requests landed on mismatched instances saw a token validation failure. That is why retrying sometimes worked: a retry could land on a consistent pair of instances.

Impact on This Account

1,470 checkouts failed platform-wide during the 116-minute window. Aurelia's share was 312 failed checkouts. Of those, 244 buyers completed a purchase later the same day. The residual loss attributable to the account was estimated at 68 orders.

Aurelia was affected more visibly than its traffic share alone would suggest because it was running a pre-festive campaign that day.

Resolution and Seller Position

The release was rolled back within 34 minutes of detection and re-released as 4.12.1 with a version compatibility guard the following day.

On the 13 August call Ritika accepted the explanation without dispute. Her only request was notification: she wanted to know that a platform incident was in progress rather than discovering it from her own customer complaints. That request was passed to Operations and is being considered as a seller status notification capability.

No compensation was requested or offered.